

Dealership
Name
Date

Interview
Lux
Irena
5/2/17

Background Questions

How long have you been in business or in current role?

5 years... opened in 2012. Irena has been in automotive for 13 years doing a little bit of everything.

How long have you been a NextGear customer?

What are some of your goals?

Make more profit. Get to 100 units/month but doesn't see that as obtainable. Currently sells about 85/month

How do you want to grow your business?

Get more vehicles... with the goal to sell half the lot a month. Increasing the total units would increase the total sold.

Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?

What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?

What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?

Irena liked AFC's ease of use for the Code Word of the day number... Darrin showed her an easier way to do it with NextGear (training issue)
Manheim Auction site

What are your favorite websites and why?

NextGear Related Questions

Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?

Make payments, floor vehicles. Irena gets annoyed by being logged out so quickly.

"Between paying off vehicle and figuring commissions, I get logged out". "It logs me out faster than my bank".

Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?

What do you typically do?

Checks bank account to see if she can buy vehicles. Irena is brought the approved deals, checks the numbers, checks the mechanicals. Sends wires through Bank of America.

When do you typically log on to myNextGear?

Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?

Do you do anything after using myNextGear?

"the girls"... two employees that sit in the office/dungeon with Irena.

Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?

Are there certain features of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?

Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?

Only uses mobile while on vacation, to make payments or check titles.

Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?

Yes.

AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?

Competitive Analysis

When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?

Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?

When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything

How do you determine which floor planning company to use?

Additional Dialogue

They buy wholesale through the 4 buyer/partners

"Your website is very easy to use". "you're the best".

"Sometimes I'm lazy and I don't want to look".

Dealership	Interview
Name	Law
Date	Tonya (Owner) and Leon (GM)
	5/2/17
Background Questions	
How long have you been in business or in current role?	5 years... opened in 2012. Tonya has been in retail for 21 years
How long have you been a NextGear customer?	
What are some of your goals?	We all want to grow. We want to constantly improve and keep up with the market. Business changes constantly. We even talk to our competitors... like Ricky across the street.
How do you want to grow your business?	"Buy low and sell high". We want quick turn around and higher volume. "People going through credit unions are killing dealerships". People know not to buy warranties. They've recently switched from \$50k+ units to under \$50k... "they're easier to sell".
Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?	"Everything". "This is a big overhead business. We have a new body shop... how can we improve?"
What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?	Always auto.
What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?	Inventory Plus (DMS) - easy to use. AutoTrader, Cars.com, DealerFire for pricing, Competitors sites to see who's better/worse.
What are your favorite websites and why?	
NextGear Related Questions	
Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?	Every day... checking line of credit, paying off cars, checking inventory... "I don't trust anybody with banking"
Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?	
What do you typically do?	
When do you typically log on to myNextGear?	
Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?	Only one account... but the title girl does log in under Tonya's credentials.
Do you do anything after using myNextGear?	
Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?	Only use mobile while I travel.
Are there certain features of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?	Very good system unless you're out in the boonies (told story about not having internet in the mountains of Italy... couldn't pay off cars).
Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?	
Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?	Yes. If it's a finance deal I will pay right away. If it's a check I will wait the 10 days for the funds to clear.
AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?	No.
Competitive Analysis	
When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?	No. Used to have AFC, but it took 8 weeks to get a title.
Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?	
When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything	
How do you determine which floor planning company to use?	
Additional Dialogue	
	They buy wholesale through the 4 buyer/partners
	"Your website is very easy to use". "you're the best".
	"Sometimes I'm lazy and I don't want to look".
	"Disappearing title" - when a unit from auction is sold/paid off and title takes 8-weeks to show up. Need more visibility here.

Dealership	Interview
Name	M&I
Date	Anna
	5/2/17
Background Questions	
How long have you been in business or in current role?	Business since 2004, her since 2005.
How long have you been a NextGear customer?	
What are some of your goals?	
How do you want to grow your business?	
Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?	
What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?	She started in auto after moving to United States... after finishing school. Worked in exports (heav container shipping)
What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?	AutoSoft for inventory and accounting
What are your favorite websites and why?	
NextGear Related Questions	
Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?	Closing deals, payroll, Accounts Receivable Report
Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?	
What do you typically do?	
When do you typically log on to myNextGear?	
Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?	Masha... does the job when Anna is out.
Do you do anything after using myNextGear?	
Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?	Never mobile.
Are there certain feature of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?	
Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?	Would be nice to see Unapplied Funds History... where did they come from? It takes a long time to reimburse unapplied. "Customer Service pays off our cars - that's not good". NGC is NOT as personal as AFC because of the size of the company. "I don't have time to go back to the website to check if NextGear completed the work". "If I ask for something to get floored I don't want to check to see if it got done"
Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?	Auto ACH stopped working once... racking up late fees. AFC doesn't charge late fees right away... gives a grace period.
AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?	Would use if there were no mistakes (like auto ACH that stopped working)... but it depends on extensions. At a certain point, the system doesn't show the 'extend' button because it expects payoff... "If I don't pay it off, I need it on my floorplan". Sometimes automatic things are good but you need to catch things too"
Competitive Analysis	
When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?	AFC - have an account but don't use it.
Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?	
When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything	
How do you determine which floor planning company to use?	
Additional Dialogue	
	Trade in allowance can be more than ACV
	Bill of sale shows allowance
	Floored in the system by stock number not the price (has happened 4 or 5 times)
	Gets logged out too quickly - quicker than bank.
	"Very rarely do things get done right with corporate".
	Prefers to contact AE (Darrin) than to self help on MyNextGear
	"would be nice when I go to the vehicle payment screen, I could see if NextGear has the title and what the status is". (add a column from other screen).

Dealership	Interview
Name	Elite
Date	Steve and Alex 5/2/17
Background Questions	
How long have you been in business or in current role?	2004. Steve handles inventory, marketing, reconditioning. Alex handles financing and sales.
How long have you been a NextGear customer?	
What are some of your goals?	Net \$850/900 per unit. 80/50/50/30 rule... Contact 80% of leads... 50% convert to floor-ups... 50% qualify... close 30% (closing at 6%). Goal is 2,000 leads and 7% close (140 units). Gross \$3.300 per unit
How do you want to grow your business?	Bought a lot in Peoria... wants to transition to that location where he's not paying Chicago premiums on location. etc.
Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?	
What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?	
What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?	DealerTrack
What are your favorite websites and why?	
NextGear Related Questions	
Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?	Steve and Alex don't typically use MyNextGear... he has the "finance girls" (employees) use it.
Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?	
What do you typically do?	
When do you typically log on to myNextGear?	
Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?	
Do you do anything after using myNextGear?	
Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?	Rarely uses either.
Are there certain features of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?	"Your payoff is quick, quick, quick... like Amazon".
Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?	Training and onboarding (like a DMS) "You have everything people just don't know how to use it."
Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?	
AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?	
Competitive Analysis	
When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?	AFC - got AFC to help with the pain of purchasing units in Canada. Canada requires a 30-day hold. He can do "riskier deals" with AFC.
Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?	
When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything	
How do you determine which floor planning company to use?	
Additional Dialogue	
	Buys units daily from wholesalers... not auctions Wonders why the UX team is there since we're far better than the competition already. "Have you seen CDK or Reynolds & Reynolds?" spends \$120k in tv advertising Prefers a choice on notifications... day, time, SMS, email, Sold 158 in March... 130+ in April "If nobody asks me, it must be working." "You guys are already above and beyond the competition."

Dealership	Interview
Name	GMotors
Date	Jeff
	5/3/17
Background Questions	
How long have you been in business or in current role?	2009... Jeff joined part-time to help his brother-in-law with the books in 2010... been there ever since. Current role is Controller handling payroll, floorplanning, insurance, Quick Books.
How long have you been a NextGear customer?	Since the beginning
What are some of your goals?	They are #1 for Allied Loans (commerical truck loans)
How do you want to grow your business?	Recently opened a second location
Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?	No.
What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?	Owned a construction company... then 2008 hit.
What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?	Manheim, Smart Auction, PNC Bank, Frazier (DMS) - it's simple and fast and the end of the month I export from NGC to Frazier.
What are your favorite websites and why?	
NextGear Related Questions	
Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?	"All day, every day. Usually every morning." Likes to keep NGC current with DMS
Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?	Mornings.
What do you typically do?	
When do you typically log on to myNextGear?	Pulls report from DMS for comparison sake. "There's no routine here." "Title day is Fridav."
Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?	No. Only Jeff. Megan sometimes helps with payoffs. It's more job function than trust as to why he's the only user.
Do you do anything after using myNextGear?	
Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?	Mostly desktop... "The phone app doesn't give me the same options." (Darrin shows him the functionality he was missing).
Are there certain feature of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?	No.
Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?	When curtailments are due, I'd like to schedule payments (this is what Darrin showed him)
Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?	
AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?	Would only use if planned/out of office.
Competitive Analysis	
When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?	"No. You guys locked us down." Used to have AFC, but got too complicated. Almost switched to Allied but their curtailment periods were monthly.
Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?	
When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything	
How do you determine which floor planning company to use?	
Additional Dialogue	
	Line of credit is 1.8m... but have a temp increase to 2.1m

Dealership Name	Interview United
Date	George and Jeff 5/3/17
Background Questions	
How long have you been in business or in current role?	3 years and 7 months. Both share the duties... George is handing financing off to a new hire.
How long have you been a NextGear customer?	
What are some of your goals?	"Under promise and over deliver." Sell a lot of cars and make a lot of money. Sees car sales changing over next 5 years. Sees a greeter and closer. Is exploring a buyer/seller contract idea. Wants to captivate the customer and make people happy.
How do you want to grow your business?	Recently hired a finance guy to focus on backend/upsell opportunities. Has a 4.7 star rating on Google with over 60 reviews in 3 months. Referral, referrals, referrals. "You have to be different."
Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?	"Constantly facing challenges on how to be better. How to differentiate ourselves." "It's context not content." "You don't remember what you did for yourself when you die."
What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?	Wholesaler for 16 years. Dealer Principle of a Jaguar store. Auto industry whole life.
What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?	cargurus, ebay (people go there), autotrader. Truetarget to price units.
What are your favorite websites and why?	
NextGear Related Questions	
Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?	Jeff is the primary user. Buying is a group decision almost entirely through wholesalers/dealers. 8am to look at curtailments and approvals.
Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?	
What do you typically do?	
When do you typically log on to myNextGear?	
Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?	Jeff, George, Diane
Do you do anything after using myNextGear?	
Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?	Desktop... no mobile. "I like to see things big."
Are there certain features of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?	Title release. Chase requires it to sell the unit.
Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?	
Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?	
AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?	Good idea... but needs overrides in the event you sell the unit. (The dealer would rather pay off the vehicle than a curtailment and additional fee)
Competitive Analysis	
When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?	No.
Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?	
When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything	
How do you determine which floor planning company to use?	
Additional Dialogue	
	Banks with Chase but is switching to a local/better service. Likes the customer service of a smaller/local institution. Easier to floorplan through Darrin - likes the customer experience rather than self help.

Dealership
Name
Date

Interview
Chicago Auto
Ricky
5/3/17

Background Questions

How long have you been in business or in current role?

3 years. Ricky has done every aspect from sales to GM. "it's a complex business to be in." You gotta be smart about how you merchandise your stuff. Ricky tried to open his own dealership in 2010 but wasn't granted occupancy after he remodeled the building

How long have you been a NextGear customer?
What are some of your goals?

This was my dream... "I was sick of making other people money." This market and business changes constantly... you have to adapt. Can't get greedy. Referrals & repeat business should be 20-25%.

How do you want to grow your business?

Ricky just completed his best month ever. He has no specific numbers as a goal but believes independent dealers should be \$1m profit annually.

Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?
What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?
What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?

Ricky opens and closes his business 7 days a week. "You can get robbed if you're not here." "If you're not here the bus might miss you."

What are your favorite websites and why?

Frazier user. Likes ADP because it works both service AND sales... no need for separate apps. Frazier has it's limits (like out-of-state) but it's only \$400/year. It does it's job but I don't trust it. It's always a little off.

NextGear Related Questions

Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?

Yes. But Razel and Janel do most of the day-to-day. They handle floorplanning and do all the paperwork. Everything is done off bank statements.

Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?
What do you typically do?

No. Just goes to business summary.

When do you typically log on to myNextGear?

Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?

Razel and Janel.

Do you do anything after using myNextGear?

Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?

iPad or desktop - depends on what's available or what he's doing.

Are there certain feature of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?

It's pretty good. "Not really. You guys have a nice dashboard."

Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?

Not that I can think of.

Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?

AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?

I would like it. But wants to be the one that sets that up.

Competitive Analysis

When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?

Used to have Westlake but "they weren't fit." ... also had ACH at one point.

Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?

When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything

"I floor everything with you guys."

How do you determine which floor planning company to use?

Additional Dialogue

Dealership	Interview
Name	XL Auto
Date	Phil 5/3/17
Background Questions	
How long have you been in business or in current role?	Dealership opened in 2013, Phil got his wholesalers license in 2009. Mike does financing, Phil acquires and floorplans through Manheim. Does a lot of work through his AE (Darrin).
How long have you been a NextGear customer?	Since opening in 2013. Specializes in imports and unique units.
What are some of your goals?	50 units/month... that's the bank's goal. Currently housing 90 units and just bought/remodeled the building they're in.
How do you want to grow your business?	Currently remodeling the other half of their warehouse. Will allow for more units.
Is there anything about your business that keeps you up at night? What is it?	No. It's very manageable.
What did you do before being involved in the auto sales industry? What positions?	Started in industry in 2003 as a wholesaler.
What types of web sites do you visit regularly? Why?	cargurus (#1 site), cars.com, autoTrader, DealerAspire (sp?), carsforsale, facebook ads (lots of hits from Facebook. Currently spending \$1k/mo on FB)
What are your favorite websites and why?	Zeus (DMS) it works for us... only \$125/mo. InventoryPlus is fantastic. AuctionGenius I really like but the notifications are screwy. For \$695 it works good enough.
NextGear Related Questions	
Do you use myNextGear.com? When? What do you use it for? Why?	On there all the time... almost exclusively uses mobile.
Do you do anything to prepare to use myNextGear.com?	No. Uses as needed
What do you typically do?	
When do you typically log on to myNextGear?	
Does anyone else use myNextGear at your company? What do they use it for? Does this cause you any problems?	
Do you do anything after using myNextGear?	
Do you use the desktop site or mobile site? When? Why?	Uses both... mainly mobile.
Are there certain features of myNextGear that make your job easier? What are they? How do they do it?	Ease of payments. Flooring is done quick. There's not too much to it.
Are there any features missing that make it hard to work with myNextGear? Which ones? How would they help you?	
Do you make payments on myNextGear? Why? Is it at a certain time of day?	
AutoPay feature discussion: would you use it?	
Competitive Analysis	
When you floor vehicles, what is the typical amount you look to spend on a floored vehicle?	Had AFC - when he was looking to get more money. They worked better with Adesa. He is exclusively with NextGear Capital now.
Do you use any other floor planning services? Which ones?	
When you floor plan with these companies, what makes you floor plan with them? Is there anything	
How do you determine which floor planning company to use?	

Additional Dialogue